# Team Caplet: where everything stands, Fri 23 Oct 2026 (with the Wharton emails)

AI-generated review (Claude Code), about 15:00-16:30 Sydney. Sources:

- the live Caplet Drive folder (read only);
- GitHub `main` at `fb41d9b`;
- the Wharton emails from 15 Sep to 19 Oct, which a student pasted (the recipient's details are left out);
- the Box TNA requirements;
- treasury.gov to the 22 Oct close.

Evidence files are in `research/assistant_review_2026-10/oct23/`.

## 1. Next 17 hours: the TNA (due Fri 23 Oct 5:00 pm ET = Sat 24 Oct 08:00 Sydney; no late submissions)

Drive shows no sign the TNA has been submitted. The draft in the "Trading Note Reflection" tab (edited 23 Oct 14:36) is **not ready**.

| # | Problem now | What the fix must achieve |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **Slot 1 is broken.** The heading names the Feb-2037 bond, the note under it is the Nov-2041 note, and the reflection cell is empty. | One pick, its exact WInS note, and a reflection of 100 words or fewer. |
| 2 | **IBTR was dropped, but its test has now been crossed.** At the 22 Oct close the basis-D ladder cost **$302,863** (MODEL; a second method gives $303,994), above $300,000. The 10/20/30-year yields have fallen 0.31/0.36/0.35 points since 6 Oct. On 21 Oct the cost was still $298,004. | Strongly consider putting IBTR back: it is the one decision that was **tested** and the note's prediction came true. Date it ("22 Oct close"), because a single close can reverse. State what the plan already does: the 2028 deposit completes the ladder and the facility minimum absorbs the gap, not the payments. Quote no dollar level. |
| 3 | **VT: "about 7.5% a year per JPMorgan" is still there.** It is false: JPMorgan's 2026 world-stock figure is 7.00%; 7.5% is the non-US developed figure. The IPS uses 7%. | Use 7% or no forecast. |
| 4 | **IBTM: "clear yield" and "matures on a set date" are still there.** Both are false; the fund closes "on or about" 15 Dec with a payout that is not predictable. Both contradict the team's own note. | Remove them; keep the note's "payout is not fixed". |
| 5 | **IBTM: "a stock crash will not make her promise fail" is an absolute.** "One of the two roots" is misleading. | Use the case's credibility idea and the rounded-down minimum instead. |
| 6 | **VT: "9%" is not labelled.** It is the WInS share; in Laura's real plan stocks are about 7%. | Say which portfolio it refers to. |
| 7 | **The Nov-41 note claims "no iBonds funds 2037-43".** This is UNVERIFIED. | Check it on iShares before relying on it in a reflection. |
| 8 | **The Doc's instructions prompt is not the official wording.** It says "goals, objectives, or constraints" where the official text says "goals, funding needs, or risk considerations". | Write to the official words in the Box/repo PDF (unchanged since 10 Sep). |

**Submit:** use the three-case rule. Per the emails, stages open by date: the IPS stage opens Mon 26 Oct. So **Case 1 (press Submit on the TNA) is the expected case**, and pressing it cannot lock an IPS form that does not exist yet. Screenshot the confirmation.

*Correction to my 23 Oct chat message:* the "Advanced to Next Stage" email came 18 days after that team's roster submit, on the morning TNA submissions opened (12 Oct). So it was triggered by the date, not by the submit.

## 2. What the emails settle (all official Wharton text)

- **Submission windows:**
  - TNA from Mon 12 Oct;

  - **IPS from Mon 26 Oct** (open the form then: earliest about 15:00 Sydney Mon 26, realistically Tue 27 07:00, before the 27 Oct meeting);
  - Final Report and school documentation from 9 Nov.
- **Freeze: "Trading ends on November 6 at 5:00 p.m. ET" = Sat 7 Nov 09:00 Sydney**, the same moment the IPS is due. US markets close at 4 pm, so an order placed after the close almost certainly never fills. Keep the Wed 4 Nov last-order rule. (GitHub `main` still says 4:00 pm in about 37 files.)
- **IPS is a SurveyMonkey Apply form, not a PDF** (Week 4 email). The public IPS PDF still says PDF/5 MB, and no public form spec exists. Unknowns:
  - field limits (SMApply character limits count spaces);
  - whether headings count;
  - whether formatting is kept. The pitch is 49 words (53 with its heading), so it could be over 50 if headings count.
- **Final Report instructions:** Mon 9 Nov 09:00 ET = **Tue 10 Nov 01:00 Sydney** (the pack said Mon 9 Nov 16:00).
- **"Week 2 email" = Mon 5 Oct 08:07 EDT** (not 6 Oct; about 15 pack files say 6 Oct). It came about 38 h before the IBTM order, so the "refined" timing holds. The Week 1 email (28 Sep) had already limited both contributions to WInS-listed securities.
- **Other rules confirmed:**
  - projections start from the case cash flows with "reasonable return assumptions"; never add WInS gains or losses;
  - "Teams are not permitted to contact the client";
  - a participation credential needs "all requirements" and "all deliverables" (including the school documentation);
  - removing a member without approval means disqualification;
  - weekly emails come on Mondays and are also posted on WInS;
  - office hours are Mon-Fri 9-5 ET (00:00-08:00 Sydney now; 01:00-09:00 from 2 Nov);
  - more than 7,300 teams this year.
- **Stock floor:** the original 28 Sep rule was "$5 or higher", later dropped. **New since 20 Oct:** the FAQ now bans "Individual" TIPS/STRIPS rather than all TIPS/STRIPS. Whether funds holding them are allowed is UNVERIFIED. No current holding is affected.
- **The 8-digit number in the WInS username is shared across Knox teams**: it is not Caplet-specific. Keep it out of public files anyway.

## 3. Drive: state of the team's work

- **Only three files changed since 18 Oct.**
  - IPS Report (today): eight old tabs removed; the strategy is now "Root & Branch".
  - Final Report (20 Oct).
  - The portfolio sheet (20 Oct).
- **No sign on Drive** that the 20 Oct meeting was held, decisions were logged or roles assigned.
- **IPS V5:** pending suggestions resolved; IPS 492 words (495 with heading).
  - **"Her other holdings"** reads as outside money, against the case.
  - **Stale or vote-dependent figures:**
  - "$136,000" (now about $137-138k, and moving with yields; after the 22 Oct close, re-check);
  - "about 5.15%" (undated);
  - "$21,000" (canonical $19,488 on the holdings basis);
  - "three of four" (false if 3r as written is voted: 44.5%).
  - **Contradictions with the TNA:** 7% vs 7.5%; "covered at purchase" vs notes that rely on reinvested coupons.
- **Final Report doc:** none of the prep items exist yet (decision log, roles, sources, Works Cited structure, numbers card). The journal still stops at 7 Oct.
- **Portfolio sheet:** the Trade Log is empty, and units and cash show $300,000 against 11 fills and $3,513.79 cash. No sign of trades after 8 Oct.

## 4. GitHub

- `main` is now `fb41d9b`: 37 commits and PRs #12-#17 after the base of our branch.

- **17 restructured the repo into `keel/` (office), `caplet/`, `toolkit/` and `archive/`. The repo is now private.**
- `main` already has the IPS-as-form change and the TIPS/STRIPS ban.
- Our branch `claude/dazzling-galileo-fx6bbm` (review folders plus fixes) is based on the old `main`, so it will conflict if merged. The email-fact patch (6 files, 64 tests pass) was built for the old layout and needs redoing on the new one.
- Still to fix on `main`:
  - the WInS username in two routine files;
  - the 4:00 pm freeze time;
  - PDF-era IPS steps;
  - the "6 Oct email" date.

## 5. Calendar from here (Sydney)

| When | What |
|---|---|
| Sat 24 Oct 08:00 | **TNA deadline** (no late submissions) |
| Mon 26 Oct ~15:00 (US Mon) | IPS form opens; look at its fields on Tue 27 07:00 at the latest |
| Tue 27 Oct 20:00 | Vote set B (coupon cover; Laura's half; top rule). Re-run the numbers on the latest close first: the 22 Oct close puts the ladder over $300k |
| Thu 29 Oct 05:00 | FOMC statement (2:00 pm ET Wed 28) |
| Sun 1 Nov | US clocks change: Sydney = ET + 16 h |
| Wed 4 Nov | Last day to place any WInS order (team rule) |
| Sat 7 Nov 09:00 | **IPS due and trading freeze** (5:00 pm ET Fri 6 Nov) |
| Tue 10 Nov 01:00 | Final Report instructions posted |
| Sat 5 Dec 09:00 | **Final Report + school documentation due** (Fri 4 Dec is a Knox staff day; get the letter signed by Fri 27 Nov) |